

CB quick-start (sdroxide — 11 m)

A short, task-oriented walkthrough for getting **sdroxide** going on the **11 m (27 MHz)** citizens band: setting up your SDR or CAT rig, using the per-country channel plans, and following the WSJT-CB digital traffic. For the reference detail behind each control, see [USER _MANUAL.md](#); for the why of this fork, see the [README](#).

This is the CB/SWL fork of sdroxide. The 11 m band and the broadcast bands are added on top; the amateur bands and everything else are upstream and unchanged.

Nederlands: [cb-quickstart.nl.md](#). Français: [cb-quickstart.fr.md](#). Italiano: [cb-quickstart.it.md](#). PDF: [cb-quickstart.en.pdf](#).

Bold names such as **SETTINGS** and **Callsign** are buttons and fields exactly as they appear on screen. Settings > Radio is a menu path.

What you need

- **An SDR or a radio sdroxide supports.** For 11 m the usual choices are:
 - **RTL-SDR** (dongle) — native, no SoapySDR needed.
 - **RX-888 / RX-888 Mk2** — native; the firmware is uploaded to the receiver automatically.
 - **Airspy HF+** (Dual / Discovery / Ranger) — native, 0.5 kHz–31 MHz.
 - Also possible: HackRF, Airspy R2/Mini, SDRplay RSP, ELAD, PlutoSDR, or a **CAT rig** (Icom/Yaesu/Xiegu) over a serial port + sound card, TCI, OpenHPSDR, or SoapySDR.
- **A 27 MHz antenna** suited to your receiver.
- **sdroxide installed** (below).

Installing

- **Windows** — the installer (.msi) or the portable .zip (which contains sdroxide.exe): see the [Releases page](#).
- **Linux** — the **AppImage** (one file, chmod +x and run), the .deb, or the portable tarball.
- **macOS** — the .dmg.

You can also run sdroxide as a **server** and open it in a browser: `sdroxide --server`, then `http://localhost:4950`. Handy when the antenna is somewhere else.

Part A — One-time setup

Everything here is saved under `~/.config/sdroxide-brown/`, so you do it once.

1. Start sdroxide

The main window has the control bar across the top and the panadapter and waterfall below it.

2. Pick your radio

Open **SETTINGS** and go to the **Radio** tab. Pick your interface (for example **RTL-SDR**, **RX-888** or **Airspy HF+**), then the **sample rate** and the **gain**. Changes apply right after **Apply / reconnect**.

- **Linux — USB receivers:** install the bundled udev rules, or sdroxide will see the device but fail to open it: `sudo cp 60-sdroxide-*.rules /usr/lib/udev/rules.d/ && sudo udevadm control --reload`, then replug.
- **Windows — RX-888:** bind the device to **WinUSB** once with [Zadig](#) — for **both** USB ids (04B4:00F3 and 04B4:00F1).

3. Fill in your details

Go to the **General** tab:

- **Callsign** — for CB/WSJT-CB, enter your CB identifier here.
- **Locator / grid** — your Maidenhead grid; the map and the decoding use it.
- **IARU region** — the region that sets the band plan.
- **CB plan** — pick your country's channel plan: **World / freeband**, **CEPT/EU** (the Netherlands), **Germany 80 channels**, **UK 27/81**, **USA**, **Australia**. This is what decides the channels and the channel number shown on the waterfall.

Part B — Listening on 11 m

1. Pick the **11 m** band on the band bar. It runs from **26.965 to 27.860 MHz**.
2. With the **CEPT/EU** plan, **channel 1 = 26.965 MHz** and **channel 40 = 27.405 MHz** (10 kHz spacing). The channel number appears on the panadapter.
3. Pick the **mode**: **AM** or **FM** for voice, **USB/LSB** for SSB on the freeband.
4. **Listening only?** Turn on **SWL mode**: every transmit control (PTT, TUNE, CALL CQ, ...) disappears and you are left with a clean receiver. With **Simple UI** you see only the controls you need, with **AM • FM • USB • LSB** up front.

Part C — Digital on 27 MHz (WSJT-CB / FT8 family)

This fork speaks the same hashed WSJT exchange that [WSJT-CB](#) uses on 27 MHz.

1. Pick **FT8** (or FT4/FT2).
2. Pick the digital channel from the channel plan / channel list of your CB plan.

3. In the **decode list**: click a row to move your audio onto that signal and press **REPLY** or **Call CQ**.
 4. Every decoded station shows its **country flag** — sdioxide follows WSJT-CB's callsign conventions and country numbering.
 5. In **SWL mode** you can read it all without transmitting.
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Part D — Saving your setup (profiles)

Under **Settings > Profiles** you save a whole working setup under a name and put it back later with one click: dials and VFOs, mode and filters, gain, drive and antennas, the digital identity and the band stacks. Handy for switching between “11 m at home” and “listening to shortwave”.

Part E — Extras

- **CW on your keyboard**: hold the **Space** bar — your keyboard works as a straight key.
 - **Export the decode list** to **CSV** or a *received-report* **ADIF**, for keeping track of what was on the air.
 - The **browser client** can **import** ADIF and **CHIRP** files.
 - **Audible alerts** for calls and new DXCC/grids.
 - **Themes**: ten extra colour themes.
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Sending on CB

- **CB is meant for sending *and* receiving, and in most countries it needs no licence** — the licence-free CEPT channels, at limited power. This fork treats 11 m as a full band, not a receive-only extra.
- **To transmit, switch on Allow transmit on 11 m (CB)** on the General tab and confirm the note once. It is a switch only because the program's amateur-band lockout is generic and refuses every band that is not an amateur allocation; CB is a separate radio service, so it is opted into rather than assumed. After that, transmitting on 11 m works like any other band.
- **To send the digital modes (FT8, SSTV) you need a transceiver**, keyed either by **VOX** (a sound-card rig — the program plays the audio to its mic input and the radio keys itself) or over **CAT**. A receive-only dongle (most RTL-SDR, RX-888 and Airspy HF+ setups) hears them but cannot send them.
- The switch opens **11 m and nothing else** — the broadcast bands stay receive-only. (`--oob-tx / tx_ham_only = false` remains for licensed out-of-band use.)
- Keep to your country's channels, power and modes — ordinary CB courtesy. **Check the current rules where you are.**
- This fork is for the whole of CB — voice and the digital modes — alongside SWL and decoding. CB and amateur radio are neighbours on the same spectrum; this

program is glad to serve both.

Help and links

- [README](#) — the full overview of the fork.
- [USER_MANUAL.md](#) — the manual, control by control.
- [WSJT-CB](#) — the digital 11 m project this builds on.
- [Releases](#) — the latest build for every platform.

See you on 11 metres! 73